Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 30 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Partly cloudy	Mostly clear	Overcast	Overcast
16° 11°	15° 8°	15° 10°	15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Brace yourselves, as new budget forecasts suggest we're facing some 'painful' years ahead with living standards set to fall.**

Think tanks are warning that the growth in living standards is grinding almost to a halt. It's a stark outlook following the latest budget announcements.

ECONOMY · UK

2 **Thousands of jobs could be at risk as Poundland bosses are reportedly filing a notice to appoint administrators.**

This news could mean a very uncertain future for the popular retailer and its staff across the country. It's a worrying time for everyone involved.

BUSINESS · UK

3 **Huge disruption is expected for hundreds of GP practices across England and Wales after a tech firm collapsed, losing online services.**

GP leaders are warning that this will cause significant issues for patients trying to access appointments and services. It's a major setback for digital healthcare.

HEALTH · UK

4 **Despite billions invested, serious pollution by the water industry remains stubbornly high, according to new reports.**

Almost all of England's water companies were rated 'poor' or 'requiring improvement' on environmental targets. It seems there's still a long way to go to clean up our waterways.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

5 **Dramatic CCTV footage shown in court reveals a train crew member using a frying pan to stop an attacker.**

The court heard the crew member showed 'sheer courage and bravery' in seeking to save lives. It sounds like a truly heroic act.

CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Great news for Liverpool's creative scene, as the long-awaited Littlewoods film studios plan has been given a £20 million Budget boost.**

This significant investment could finally kickstart the redevelopment of the iconic site. It's a huge step forward for the city's film and TV industry.

ON AIR — Could Liverpool become the new Hollywood of the North with this kind of investment?

FILM · UK

2 **Sam Fender fans faced a 'bot attack' during pre-sale for his Newcastle shows, causing tickets to be moved.**

The singer confirmed a 'sophisticated' attack affected the website selling tickets. Hopefully, genuine fans will still get their chance to see him perform.

ON AIR — Have you ever had a nightmare trying to get tickets for a popular artist because of bots?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **The singer of 'Babydoll' says life will 'never be the same again' after scoring a UK number one hit.**

After a difficult period that led them to quit music, the artist is now finding genuine joy in life again. It's a fantastic comeback story!

ON AIR — What's your favourite comeback story in music, or any field?

MUSIC · UK

4 **If you're looking for a good read, thrillers, self-help, and Harry Potter were the big winners for readers this year.**

New data from Libraries NI reveals what books people were turning pages and turning up the volume for. It seems we all love a bit of escapism and self-improvement!

ON AIR — What's the last book that really gripped you, or a self-help book that made a difference?

BOOKS · UK

5 **Popular YouTuber Jacksepticeye is branching out, suggesting 'the internet's a less whimsical place' now.**

Seán McLoughlin, who made his name playing video games, is now more likely to be seen in other ventures. It sounds like he's evolving with the times.

ON AIR — Do you think the internet has lost some of its fun and spontaneity over the years?

INTERNET · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England secured a consolation win in the tri-series, with Ben Duckett hitting 167 and Liam Dawson taking four wickets against Sri Lanka.**

It was a strong performance to end the series on a high note. A good confidence boost for the team.

ON AIR — What do you think this win means for England's morale going forward?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Sergio Garcia is targeting a Ryder Cup return as he confirms his exit from LIV Golf, rejoining the DP World Tour.**

This is big news for golf fans, as one of the sport's biggest names makes a move back to the traditional tour. Could we see him back in blue?

ON AIR — Do you think we'll see Sergio Garcia back in the Ryder Cup, and would you welcome it?

GOLF · UK

3 **Manchester United head coach Michael Carrick has confirmed Bruno Fernandes will remain captain, addressing his own future before Saturday's trip to Chelsea.**

This news brings some clarity to the captaincy debate at Old Trafford. All eyes will be on Stamford Bridge this weekend.

ON AIR — Is Bruno Fernandes the right man to lead Manchester United, especially with a big game against Chelsea coming up?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Both Celtic and Rangers will play their next Scottish Cup home ties behind closed doors after appeals against sanctions were dismissed.**

This decision means no fans will be in attendance for these crucial matches. It's a tough blow for supporters.

ON AIR — How much of an impact do you think playing behind closed doors will have on the atmosphere and the teams' performances?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Alessia Russo scored a hat-trick as Arsenal beat Benfica 3-0, making her England's all-time leading goalscorer in the Women's Champions League.**

What an incredible achievement for Russo! It was a dominant performance from Arsenal in the Women's Champions League.

ON AIR — How important is Alessia Russo to Arsenal and England's success right now?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **Many are discovering the unexpected joy of 're-reading a favourite childhood book' and rediscovering its magic.**
   It seems a trip down memory lane, revisiting the tales that first captured our imaginations, is a popular way to unwind and feel a sense of nostalgic comfort.

2. **The simple act of 'waving at a passing train driver' is being highlighted as a surprisingly uplifting moment in the day.**
   For both the waver and the waved-at, this small, friendly gesture can bring a brief spark of connection and cheer to an otherwise ordinary journey.

3. **There's a quiet appreciation growing for the 'art of perfectly peeling an orange' in one continuous strip.**
   This surprisingly satisfying skill is being celebrated as a small victory in the kitchen, proving that even the simplest tasks can offer a moment of focused enjoyment.

4. **The delightful discovery of 'an old, forgotten photograph' in a dusty album is bringing smiles to many faces.**
   Unearthing these visual snippets from the past sparks happy memories and offers a charming glimpse into bygone days and familiar faces.

5. **People are finding comfort and fascination in the 'watching bubbles in a washing machine' as it goes through its cycle.**
   The swirling patterns and gentle movement offer a hypnotic, calming spectacle, turning a household chore into a moment of quiet observation.

6. **The satisfying click of 'completing a jigsaw puzzle' is proving to be a highly rewarding pastime for many.**
   The sense of accomplishment, combined with the meditative process of fitting pieces together, makes it a popular choice for winding down.

7. **There's a growing trend for people to embrace the 'joy of a freshly baked loaf of bread' as a simple luxury.**
   The aroma, the warmth, and the delicious taste of homemade bread are bringing a touch of comforting artisan charm to kitchens across the country.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new piece of furniture will fit through the doorway, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: HOLDING OUR ARMS OUT TO MEASURE THE WIDTH, OFTEN BUMPING INTO THINGS IN THE PROCESS!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF THE COFFEE BEANS OR GROUNDS BEFORE BREWING, JUST TO SAVOUR THE AROMA!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' just looks incredibly happy or surprised, thanks to its design?**
  Perhaps it's a plug socket that looks like it's winking, or a car front that looks like it's grinning. What everyday objects have you spotted that have a surprising 'face'?

- **We all have that 'one particular piece of clothing' that we absolutely adore, even if it's a bit old or faded.**
  It might be a comfy jumper, a lucky pair of socks, or a well-worn scarf. What's that one item in your wardrobe you just can't bear to part with, and why?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that elephants communicate with each other using a special language that involves wiggling their ears in a secret code?

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Great Plague, as it killed the rats and fleas that carried the disease.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to sense sugars and other chemicals on plants.
- The world's smallest chameleon, Brookesia nana, can fit on your fingertip.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The iconic red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- There are more possible permutations of a standard deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called chernozem, found in parts of Eastern Europe and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 30 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 303 of the year, 62 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Declaration of the Slovak Nation (Slovakia); Christian feast day: Ethelnoth (Egelnoth) the Good; Christian feast day: Blessed Benvenuta Bojani; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins (Catholic, Ireland, Society of Jesus). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1945 — Lynne Marta, American actress (died 2024)
- 1954 — T. Graham Brown, American country singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Juliet Stevenson, English actress
- 1947 — Herschel Weingrod, American screenwriter and producer
- 1947 — Timothy B. Schmit, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1996 — Kennedy McMann, American actress
- 1960 — Grayson Hugh, American singer-songwriter
- 1973 — Michael Oakes, English footballer and manager

THE DAY TODAY

- 2015 — A fire in a nightclub in the Romanian capital of Bucharest kills sixty-four people and leaves more than 147 injured.
- 2005 — The rebuilt Dresden Frauenkirche (destroyed in the firebombing of Dresden during World War II) is reconsecrated after a thirteen-year rebuilding project.
- 1947 — The General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT), the foundation of the World Trade Organization (WTO), is founded.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — The Israeli-Palestinian conflict: The Madrid Conference commences in an effort to revive peace negotiations between Israel and Palestine.
- 2023 — First rescue of a prisoner during the Israeli invasion of Gaza.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1944 — Holocaust: Anne and Margot Frank are deported from Auschwitz to the Bergen-Belsen concentration camp, where they die from disease the following year, shortly before the end of WWII.
- 1961 — The Soviet Union detonates the Tsar Bomba, the most powerful explosive device ever detonated.

- 1980 — El Salvador and Honduras agree to put the border dispute fought over in 1969's Football War before the International Court of Justice.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 31 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 304 of the year, 61 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsus Rodriguez; Christian feast day: Ampliatus; Christian feast day: Begu; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Johnny Whitworth, American actor and producer
- 1976 — Piper Perabo, American actress and producer
- 1945 — Russ Ballard, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1939 — Ron Rifkin, American actor
- 1941 — Sally Kirkland, American actress (died 2025)
- 1997 — Marcus Rashford, English footballer
- 1973 — Paul Abrahams, English footballer and coach
- 1997 — Sydney Park, American actress and comedian

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2003 — Mahathir Mohamad resigns as Prime Minister of Malaysia and is replaced by Deputy Prime Minister Abdullah Ahmad Badawi, marking an end to Mahathir's 22 years in power.
- 1943 — World War II: An F4U Corsair accomplishes the first successful radar-guided interception by a United States Navy or Marine Corps aircraft.
- 1984 — Indian Prime Minister Indira Gandhi is assassinated by two Sikh security guards. Riots break out in New Delhi and other cities and around 3,000 Sikhs are killed.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1996 — TAM Transportes Aéreos Regionais Flight 402 crashes in São Paulo, Brazil, killing 99 people.
- 1994 — American Eagle Flight 4184 crashes near Roselawn, Indiana killing all 68 people on board.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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